KINKAJOU

Potos flavus

1. What can it see, hear, or feel?
Big eyes gather dim light, a keen nose finds ripe fruit, and a long tongue reaches into flowers.

2. Where does it live — and why?
It lives high in the rainforest, sleeping in tree holes by day and visiting fruit trees by night.

3. How does it send messages?
It greets friends with a snort-weedle call, hisses when angry, and marks branches with its scent.

4. What does it do when something changes?
By day it sleeps deep in its den, and if woken at night it moves quickly to other trees.

5. How does it learn?
Young kinkajous travel with their mother and learn the path from fruit tree to fruit tree.

6. How does it have babies?
A mother has one baby with eyes closed, and other group members share the den for protection.

7. What are its limits?
Daylight is a hard limit — and without tall trees, it loses both its food and its bed.

8. What does this teach us?
A night out for a kinkajou is a precise, learned journey — memory, not chance.

WHY IS THIS ANIMAL HERE?

Kinkajous live in the rainforest canopies of Central and South America.

Their forests are being cleared for logging and agriculture.

They need tall, connected trees to move safely at night.

When its habitat shrinks:

- flowering and fruiting trees become scarce
- they are pushed to the ground, where danger is higher
- they are also taken from the wild for the pet trade

This place is not their natural home, but it can help keep the species alive.

THINK ABOUT THIS

If you lived in the trees and came out only at night, how would you find your food?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.

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